

phets. But for nearly a hundred years the truth of the received dates and authors has been disputed by the school of critics which claims to be specially scientific. Their conjecture is that the writers of the prophecies are anonymous, that the date is toward the close of the Exile, and the place in Babylon, in the city or the province or the kingdom.

In the following pages it will be our endeavour to show that this conjecture, which is founded on no historical fact, is contrary to the Scriptures; is inconsistent with the known history of the period; is incompatible with obedience to the Divine command, and with a regard for their own lives on the part of the exiles; and rests on a moral contradiction by supposing a good man capable of exposing the elders of Israel to a cruel death by concealing his own name whilst he issues threats of destruction against the King of Babylon, who holds them in his grasp.